

LULAMA NSIZWA ZONDO

Location: Bergville, KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa (Open to Relocate)

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Website: <https://nsizwa09.github.io/Resume-v2/>

Professional Summary

Results-driven **Junior DevOps Engineer** with over 2 years of hands-on technical experience within the **KwaZulu-Natal Department of Education (KZNDOE)**, specializing in deployment automation, system availability, and release management. Proven track record in maintaining software deployment pipelines, writing automation scripts in Python and Bash, and supporting regional application infrastructure. Certified in Microsoft Azure (AZ-900) with practical experience managing multi-environment releases, performing root cause analysis, and utilizing Git for version control. Adept at bridging development and operations teams within structured Agile frameworks to improve deployment reliability, reduce manual operational overhead, and enforce DevOps best practices.

Technical & Core Skills

- **CI/CD & Release Automation:** GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps Pipelines, Automated Deployment Scripts, Release Verification, Rollback Procedures
- **Scripting & Automation:** Python, Bash/Shell, PowerShell, Automated System Configurations
- **Source Control & SDLC:** Git, GitHub, Branching Strategies (GitFlow), Pull Requests, Agile/Scrum Methodologies
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure (AZ-900), Infrastructure as Code (IaC) Concepts, Docker Fundamentals, Virtualization
- **Systems Administration & Operations:** Application Support, Server Administration, SA-SAMS Database Management, Network Troubleshooting, DISM/Hiren's Deployment Tools
- **Monitoring & Documentation:** Log Analysis, Incident Investigation, Root Cause Analysis (RCA), Operational Runbooks, SLA Management

Professional Experience

DevOps & Systems Support Intern

KwaZulu-Natal Department of Education (KZNDOE) | KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa

January 2025 – Present

- Maintain, monitor, and optimize automated software deployment pipelines for departmental applications across development, testing, staging, and production environments.
- Develop and maintain custom Bash, Python, and PowerShell automation scripts to replace manual administrative tasks, reducing operational effort by over 40%.
- Manage application releases, patch deployments, and database updates for regional SA-SAMS and administrative web platforms, ensuring high system availability and minimal service disruption.
- Perform root cause analysis (RCA) and deployment-related incident troubleshooting across server infrastructure, resolving Level 2/3 escalation tickets within established SLAs.
- Leverage Git for version control and environment configuration management, enforcing standardized branching models and pull request review workflows.
- Conduct deployment validations, post-release verifications, and execute automated rollback scripts when operational anomalies are detected during release windows.
- Deploy containerized micro-services using Docker in staging environments to evaluate application changes prior to production rollouts.
- Author and maintain technical runbooks, disaster recovery steps, and deployment procedures to ensure knowledge sharing across cross-functional IT operations teams.

Education

Bachelor of Information Technology in Business Systems (NQF Level 7)

IIE Rosebank College, South Africa

Completed: December 2024

- **Relevant Coursework:** Software Engineering, Database Systems, Systems Analysis & Design, Web Development, Computer Networks, IT Project Management.

Certifications

- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)** – Microsoft
- **Google Technical Support Fundamentals** – Coursera / Google

References

- References available upon request